

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Hail

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Get indoors and stay away from windows during hail. If driving, stop in a safe place out of traffic when you can; stay inside the vehicle and protect yourself from broken glass. Do not stop beneath a highway overpass.

Do now.

**Leave the open**

01

Move into a sturdy building before collecting possessions.

**Stay away from glass**

02

Use an interior room and keep pets inside.

**If in a car**

03

Pull over safely out of traffic, avoid flood-prone areas and remain in the vehicle.

**Follow other warnings**

04

Hail can accompany tornadoes, lightning and strong wind; act on those warnings as well.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Remain under substantial shelter while hail continues. Keep shoes on and avoid glazing. Afterward, assess damage from the ground; loose roofing and hidden electrical damage can be more dangerous than the hail itself.

Watch for.

Do not climb a wet or damaged roof to inspect it.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area. Decide who helps whom and who carries the essential supplies; do not send a lone child to retrieve items. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: leave the open. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Do not climb a wet or damaged roof to inspect it.

Keep essentials within reach.

For hail, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Remain under substantial shelter while hail continues. Keep shoes on and avoid glazing. Afterward, assess damage from the ground; loose roofing and hidden electrical damage can be more dangerous than the hail itself. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Check for injuries and roof or window damage only when conditions are safe. Photograph damage from ground level.

First decision: Leave the open

Move into a sturdy building before collecting possessions. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Remain under substantial shelter while hail continues. Keep shoes on and avoid glazing. Afterward, assess damage from the ground; loose roofing and hidden electrical damage can be more dangerous than the hail itself. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Do not climb a wet or damaged roof to inspect it. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Get indoors and stay away from windows during hail. If driving, stop in a safe place out of traffic when you can; stay inside the vehicle and protect yourself from broken glass. Do not stop beneath a highway overpass. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For hail, keep the specific hazard in view: Do not climb a wet or damaged roof to inspect it.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Follow other warnings. Hail can accompany tornadoes, lightning and strong wind; act on those warnings as well. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Hail · official guidance

<https://www.weather.gov/safety/thunderstorm>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/hail/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.